

The Power Brokers

MAY 4, 2009

It is a loose conglomeration of super-sized egos and prime ministerial ambitions with no ideological common ground. United by an exaggerated sense of indispensability, they all want to be the king—or kingmakers.



“Once the election results are out, the ‘Third Front’ will scramble to join one of the two main contenders for power, with each demanding a pound of flesh, followed by some hard bargaining.”

D.B.N. MURTHY, *Bangalore*

Opportunism Rules

With each constituent projecting its own prime ministerial candidate, the Third Front has no ideological commonality and the parties have grouped themselves with the sole aim of garnering the prime minister's post at any cost (“The Front Runners”, May 4). They can at best reduce the number of seats for the UPA and NDA, and play spoiler for them.

A.SRIKANTIAH, *Bangalore*

The fact that all our political formations other than the Congress, BJP and the Left have the propensity of free ions, attaching themselves to any pole, shows that a programmatic consensus has developed in India's polity even if turbocharged rhetoric suggests otherwise. This



Man for the Top Job

Sonia Gandhi has the weight around her neck that Manmohan Singh did not contest elections this time as well and it's fair if other parties want an elected member from the Lok Sabha (“Buy One Get Two”, April 27). Political manoeuvres apart, it's in the interest of the nation to have Manmohan as the prime minister to tide over the financial meltdown and restore growth.

GANTI MAHAPATRUNI RAMA RAO, *via www.indiatoday.in*

Sonia Gandhi hard-selling Manmohan Singh is akin to refurbishing an old used car and displaying it for people to buy. It will not guarantee performance in the long run but Sonia seems ready to repeat the act again.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR, *Bangalore*

intrinsic property can be leveraged to advantage if consensus is built on the norms of political conduct—respect for adversarial positioning, finesse in name-calling and decorous rhetoric.

BISHAN SAHAI,

via www.indiatoday.in

Political manoeuvring cannot be called social engineering (“Lone Star”, May 4). Mayawati's bounce comes from being a ‘Dalit-ki-beti’. Enjoying a piggyback ride on the emaciated Dalits, she captured Uttar Pradesh, but now she is exhorting other communities to join her, thereby negating the very concept of casteist prejudice and rift. A lone star, but a star that attracts to eliminate.

J.N. BHARTIYA,

via www.indiatoday.in

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